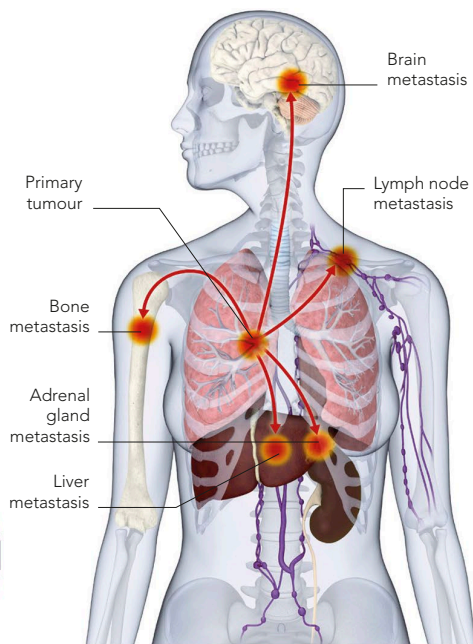
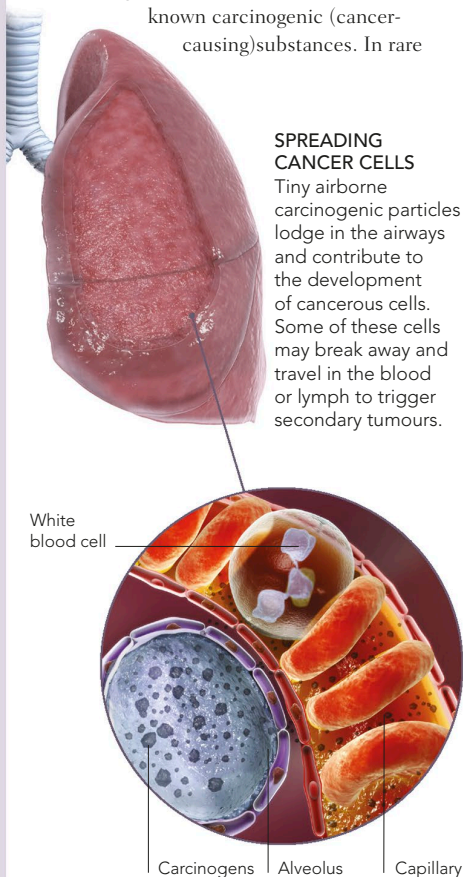


## LUNG CANCER

The most common cause of lung cancer – responsible for almost 90 per cent of all cases – is tobacco smoke. In the past, lung cancer was far more common in men than women, because more men than women smoked. However, as more women have taken up smoking, this effect has reduced. The disease is also becoming increasingly common in developing countries, with the spread of tobacco smoking and growing urban populations. Many inhaled irritants trigger the growth of abnormal cells in the lungs, but cigarette smoke contains thousands of known carcinogenic (cancer-causing) substances. In rare

cases, lung cancer is caused by asbestos, toxic chemicals, or the radioactive gas radon. A persistent cough is usually the earliest symptom. Because most people who develop lung cancer are smokers, this is often dismissed as a “smoker’s cough”. Other symptoms include coughing up blood, wheezing, weight loss, persistent hoarseness, and chest pain. If tests confirm the presence of lung cancer, a lobectomy (removal of a lung lobe) or pneumonectomy (removal of a whole lung) may be performed. This is usually advised only if the tumour is small and has not spread. Chemotherapy and radiotherapy may be given, alone or in combination.



### THE SPREAD OF LUNG CANCER

Lung cancer can spread (metastasize) to other parts of the body. Metastases in bones can cause pain and fractures; in the brain, headaches and confusion; and in the liver, weight loss and jaundice.